

Assignment 7: Phonetics

Ling 201 – Spring 2026

(100 pts total)

Please **do not use external sources such as the internet or AI to find the answers**. If you need an **extension**, please ask before the deadline. **General American pronunciation is assumed here.**

Part 1. English Consonants Identifying

Identify the **first consonants** in the given English words and provide the IPA symbol and the description (voicing, place, and manner) for it. (3 points/item, 24 points total)

example *dental* [d] voiced alveolar stop

- | | | | | |
|-----------|------|-----------|---------------|-------------------|
| 1. vote | [v] | voiced | labiodental | fricative |
| 2. this | [ð] | voiced | dental | fricative |
| 3. germ | [dʒ] | voiced | post-alveolar | affricate |
| 4. note | [n] | (voiced) | alveolar | nasal |
| 5. shock | [ʃ] | voiceless | post-alveolar | fricative |
| 6. hair | [h] | voiceless | glottal | fricative |
| 7. gone | [g] | voiced | velar | stop/plosive |
| 8. yellow | [j] | voiced | palatal | approximant/glide |

Part 2. English Vowel Identifying

Identify **the vowels** in the given English words and provide the IPA symbol and the description (height, backness, and roundedness) for it. (2 points/item, 12 points total)

example *can* [æ] front low unrounded

- | | | | | | | |
|----------|------|------|-------|-----------|-------|-------|
| 1. sit | [ɪ] | high | front | unrounded | lax | vowel |
| 2. more | [ɔ] | mid | back | rounded | lax | vowel |
| 3. booth | [u] | high | back | rounded | tense | vowel |
| 4. set | [ɛ] | mid | front | unrounded | lax | vowel |
| 5. book | [ʊ] | high | back | rounded | lax | vowel |
| 6. say | [ej] | mid | front | unrounded | tense | vowel |

Part 3. Phonetic Transcription: IPA to English

Translate the following IPA transcriptions into English spelling. (1 points/item, 10 points total)

example [kənˈfjuːʒn] confusion

- | | | | |
|-----|--------------|---|--------------|
| 1. | [wɛnzdeɪ] | → | Wednesday |
| 2. | [θaʊznd] | → | thousand |
| 3. | [ˌɪltɡəɪs] | → | Rutgers |
| 4. | [hezəteɪt] | → | hesitate |
| 5. | [beɪðɪŋsɪt] | → | bathing suit |
| 6. | [kʃʊkʌmbɜː] | → | cucumber |
| 7. | [pˈɪlɡrɪm] | → | pilgrim |
| 8. | [ælfəbetɪk] | → | alphabetic |
| 9. | [baɪlɪŋɡwəl] | → | bilingual |
| 10. | [kənsənənt] | → | consonant |

Part 4. Phonetic Transcription: English to IPA

Provide the phonetic transcription for the given English words. (2 points/item, 24 points total, question 9 and 10 count as 2 items)

example can [kæn] (Don't forget the brackets!)

- | | | | |
|-----|------------|---|---------------------|
| 1. | hit | → | [hɪt] |
| 2. | vet | → | [vɛt] |
| 3. | hood | → | [hʊd] |
| 4. | wedge | → | [wɛdʒ] |
| 5. | think | → | [θɪŋk] |
| 6. | who | → | [hu] |
| 7. | party | → | [pˈɑːrɪ] / [pˈɑːti] |
| 8. | wing | → | [wɪŋ] |
| 9. | Facebook | → | [feɪs bʊk] |
| 10. | Snow White | → | [snəʊ waɪt] |

Part 5. Sound Classes

For each description, mark all of the given IPA symbols that fit the description on the left (the number of correct answers may vary by question). Only consider symbols on the same line as the description. *(15 points total)*

1. voiced velars	[v]	[g]	[r]	[ð]	[ŋ]	[ɣ]	[k]
2. low (open) vowels	[i]	[ə]	[æ]	[o]	[ɑ]	[ɛ]	[y]
3. voiced stops/plosives	[g]	[t]	[b]	[m]	[h]	[ɟ]	[d]
4. alveolars	[n]	[s]	[β]	[θ]	[ɹ]	[ʁ]	[x]
5. rounded vowels	[æ]	[ɛ]	[ʊ]	[ɪ]	[o]	[e]	[u]

Part 6. Reading Sentences in IPA

Write the following broad phonetic transcriptions in regular English spelling. *(5 points/item, 15 points total)*

1. fəˈnetɪks ɪz ðə stədi əv spɪtʃ saʊndz

Phonetics is the study of speech sounds.

2. sʌm piːpəl θɪŋk fəˈnetɪks ɪz vɛɪ ɪntəˈrɛstɪŋ

Some people think Phonetics is very interesting.

3. ɔl spəʊkən læŋɡwɪdʒɪz dʒʌz saʊndz prədʒʌst bæɪ ðə ʌpəɪ rɛspəɪrətɔɹi sɪstəm

All spoken languages use sounds produced by the upper respiratory system.

Extra Credit

This part is **optional**. If you attempt it, you will receive *at least 1 extra point* on top of your grade. Up to **5 points** may be awarded based on the quality of your answer. (5 points)

Write a phonetic transcription for each of the *italicised words* in the following excerpt of a poem entitled *Brush Up Your English* published long ago in a British newspaper.

I take it you already know
Of tough and bough and cough and dough?
Some may stumble, but not you,
On hiccough, thorough, slough and through?
...
A moth is not a moth in mother,
Nor both in bother, broth in brother.

know	[naʊ]
tough	[tʰʌf]
bough	[baʊ]
cough	[kʰɔf] / [kʰʌf]
dough	[daʊ]
hiccough	[hɪkʰʌp]
thorough	[θʌrə]
slough	[slu] / [slʌf] / [slaw] / [slow] (multiple pronunciations)
through	[θru]
moth	[mɒθ]
mother	[mʌðəɪ] / [mʌðɪ]
both	[bəʊθ]
bother	[bəðəɪ] / [bəðɪ]
broth	[brɒθ]
brother	[brʌðəɪ] / [brʌðɪ]